

VOL. I · ISSUE 03 · OUTREACH EDITION

THE SWIPE FILE · A CLOSER'S FIELD MANUAL

20 Cold *DMs* That Book *Calls*

The LinkedIn messages closers inside Cowboy Closers use to skip the job queue and land roles paying £5K to £15K/month. Mostly LinkedIn, a few Instagram. Every DM annotated.

Connor Western

The Wolf of South East Asia
Founder, Cowboy Closers

IF THIS RESONATES

*If you read this and feel something click, the kind of click that says **this is the move**, apply to work with us at apply.cowboyclosers.com. We'll see if you're a fit, and if you are, we'll show you exactly how the rest of it works.*

HOW TO USE THIS SWIPE FILE

Most cold DMs you've seen don't work because they were written by people who don't sell. They're either too long, too templated, or too desperate.

The 20 DMs in this swipe file are different for three reasons.

One. They came from real closer placements. Every single one led to a booked call. Most led to a paid role.

Two. They're short. Every DM is under 80 words. Most are under 50.

Three. They lead with proof, not pitch. The closer demonstrates value before asking for anything.

The bulk of the swipe file is built for LinkedIn, because LinkedIn is where closers find roles. Founders are searchable. Hiring managers post the briefs. Sales leaders are one connection request away. We've kept three Instagram DMs in the file for variety, because some offers (info coaches, agency owners with personal brands) live there instead.

You don't have to copy these word for word. You have to understand why each one works and write your own version.

Read the DM. Read the annotation. Then write your version into a notes app. Send 10 a day for 14 days. Book your first call by day 5.



THE 5 RULES OF A COLD DM THAT WORKS

Rule 1: Lead with their name and a specific observation. "Hey [name], I saw your post on [topic]" beats "Hey, hope you're well."

Rule 2: Demonstrate value in the first sentence. Either show you've read their content, audited their funnel, or have a specific insight. Generic compliments get ignored.

Rule 3: One ask. One CTA. Don't ask for a call AND a Loom feedback session AND your CV to be reviewed. One thing.

Rule 4: Under 80 words. Long DMs feel like work to reply to. Short DMs feel like a conversation. Yours should feel like a conversation.

Rule 5: No "I'm looking for" energy. You're not begging for a job. You're offering value. Even if you've never closed a deal in your life, the frame is "I can help you" not "please help me."

Bonus rule for LinkedIn specifically. Connection request first, then DM. Don't waste InMail credits unless you have to. Personalise the connection note in 200 characters or less. If they don't accept in 5 days, withdraw and InMail.



DM #1: THE DIRECT AUDIT

THE DIRECT
AUDIT

LINKEDIN

#01

SEND TO: FOUNDERS RUNNING ADS TO A WEBINAR OR VSL

"Hey James, watched your webinar on Tuesday. Solid offer. One thing I noticed: your CTA at the 47 min mark drops off energy. I track close rates on calls for a living and that drop usually hits show rates by 15%. Happy to walk through it on a 15 min call if you want. No pitch."

WHY IT WORKS

- Names a specific moment in their content (proves you watched)
- Provides a real data point
- Offers value without selling
- Soft CTA with explicit "no pitch"



DM #2: THE NICHE-SPECIFIC OPENER

THE NICHE-SPECIFIC
OPENER

LINKEDIN

#02

SEND TO: ONLINE COACHES AND COURSE CREATORS IN A SPECIFIC VERTICAL

"Hey Mark, I close calls for two online fitness coaches right now. Both run a similar offer to yours. One of them was at 18% close, we got them to 31% in 6 weeks. If you're hiring closers in the next 60 days I'd love to chat. If not, I'll send you the 3 things we changed for free."

WHY IT WORKS

- Establishes you work in their niche
- Specific results with a timeframe
- Conditional ask (either we work together OR I give you value)
- No desperation



DM #3: THE STORY HOOK

THE STORY
HOOK

LINKEDIN

#03

SEND TO: ANYONE SELLING A TRANSFORMATION PRODUCT

"Hey, your story hit me. I was a sparky in Brisbane 2 years ago, hated it. Switched to closing 14 months ago and just hit my first £8K month. Now I'm picking up a second offer to close for. Yours is the one that caught my eye. Open to a chat?"

WHY IT WORKS

- Mirrors their audience (you ARE the customer they sell to)
- Shows real result
- Direct ask without being pushy
- Specific income number creates believability



DM #4: THE PROBLEM SPOTTER

THE PROBLEM
SPOTTER

LINKEDIN

#04

SEND TO: FOUNDERS AND SALES LEADERS WITH A PUBLIC FUNNEL

"Hey, opted into your funnel yesterday to test your booking flow. Took me 4 clicks to get to the calendar and the confirmation email didn't fire. That's probably costing you 15 to 20% of booked calls. I'm a closer but I also know funnels. Want me to send a 3 min Loom showing the fixes?"

WHY IT WORKS

- Demonstrates you took action (opted in)
- Specific friction point
- Quantified cost
- Loom is a low-friction CTA



DM #5: THE WARM REFERRAL

THE WARM
REFERRAL

LINKEDIN

#05

SEND TO: FOUNDERS AND HIRING MANAGERS CONNECTED TO CLOSERS YOU ALREADY WORK WITH

"Hey, mate of mine Liam mentioned you're scaling your closer team. I work with Liam on the [X] offer, just had my first £6K month closing for them. If you've got capacity I'd love to take a couple test calls for you. Liam can vouch."

WHY IT WORKS

- Name-drops a real person LinkedIn can verify in one click
- Specific income
- Low-risk ask (test calls, not a full role)
- Offers verification



DM #6: THE COMMENT-TO-CONNECTION

THE COMMENT-TO-CONNECTION

LINKEDIN

#06

SEND TO: ANYONE WHOSE POST YOU COMMENTED ON AND GOT A REPLY OR LIKE

"Hey, appreciated you replying to my comment on your post. I genuinely loved the breakdown you did on [topic]. Bigger question though, do you ever take on closers? I've been closing for [niche] for 11 months and your offer would slot in well to my schedule."

WHY IT WORKS

- Anchors to an existing interaction LinkedIn surfaces in their notifications
- Specific appreciation (not generic)
- Direct ask after the warmup
- Mentions schedule (suggests you have other roles, which is attractive)



DM #7: THE PORTFOLIO DROP

THE PORTFOLIO
DROP

LINKEDIN

#07

SEND TO: HIRING MANAGERS AND FOUNDERS WHO POST ABOUT SCALING OR HIRING

"Hey, saw your post about scaling. I've closed 47 deals across two offers in the last 6 months. Avg deal £4,800. Total closed £225K. If you want the breakdown I can send a Loom in 5 min. If now's not the right time, no worries, I'll send the case study anyway in case you want to see what a tight closer looks like."

WHY IT WORKS

- Hard numbers, fast
- Two options (engage now OR receive value passively)
- No pressure
- Frames you as "tight," which is what every founder wants



DM #8: THE PATTERN INTERRUPT

THE PATTERN INTERRUPT

LINKEDIN

#08

SEND TO: ANYONE RECEIVING HIGH DM VOLUME (CREATORS, EXECUTIVES, WELL-FOLLOWED FOUNDERS)

MESSAGE 01, DAY 1

"Not pitching. Not asking for a call. Just wanted to say your post on discovery questions actually changed how I run mine. The bit about asking 'what's it costing you' instead of 'what's your pain' is gold. Cheers mate."

MESSAGE 02, DAY 5

"Hey, me again. Genuinely wasn't pitching last time but now I am. Do you take on closers? I've used your framework on 30 calls and my close rate is up 12%. Happy to send a recorded call if you want proof."

WHY IT WORKS

- First DM is genuinely valuable, no ask
- Second DM references the first and asks
- Two-step pattern bypasses spam filters in their brain
- LinkedIn rewards this because the first message gets a reply, which boosts the second



DM #9: THE QUALIFIER REVERSE

THE QUALIFIER
REVERSE

LINKEDIN

#09

SEND TO: ESTABLISHED OFFERS WHERE YOU WANT TO MAKE SURE THEY'RE LEGIT

"Hey, before I send the usual closer pitch, want to make sure your offer fits how I work. Three questions. What's your AOV. What's your current close rate. And how many leads is your calendar getting per week? If the numbers work I'll send you a Loom on why I'd be a fit."

WHY IT WORKS

- You're qualifying THEM, which flips the dynamic
- Founders respect closers who care about lead quality
- Sets you up to send a custom Loom only if they reply
- High-quality signal even if no reply



DM #10: THE LOOM-FIRST APPROACH

THE LOOM-
FIRST

LINKEDIN

#10

SEND TO: COACHES AND FOUNDERS WHOSE FUNNEL YOU CAN AUDIT

MESSAGE 01

"Hey [name], I made you a 4 min Loom going through 3 things I'd change in your VSL to improve close rate. No pitch, just a give. Link's here: [Loom URL]"

MESSAGE 02, 24H LATER

"Did the Loom land? Curious what you thought."

WHY IT WORKS

- The Loom is the value
- Soft ask after
- LinkedIn allows Loom links natively in DMs and they preview as cards
- Stands out in a sea of text DMs



DMS #11-15: THE QUICK LIST

THE STAT
DROP

LINKEDIN

#11

"Closers with trades backgrounds close 23% better than average. I'm an ex-electrician 14 months into closing for fitness offers. Worth a chat?"

THE REVERSE
ASK

LINKEDIN

#12

"Hey, not looking for a role right now but if your closer team ever needs a backup I'd love to be on your list. Here's my 60-second closer reel: [link]"

THE SPECIFIC
COMPLIMENT

LINKEDIN

#13

"Your episode with [guest] on [topic] is the best thing I've heard in 6 months. The bit at 31:14 about 'cost of doing nothing' is something I'm now using on calls. Quick Q, do you take closers?"

THE TIME
HOOK

LINKEDIN

#14

"I'm in Bali for the next 2 weeks. Time zone for AU/UK calls is perfect. If you've got a UK offer that needs a closer for AU-tz calls, I'm available immediately."

THE DIRECT
PIF

LINKEDIN

#15

"Hey, no fluff. I close for [niche]. Last 30 days I did £42K in closes for one client. Want to send me 5 calls for free this week as a trial? I'll close on commission only. If I close 2 of 5 you hire me."

DMS #16-20: THE LIST CONTINUED

THE IG NICHE
OPENER

INSTAGRAM

#16

"Saw your offer on Instagram, opted in to your funnel, watched the whole VSL. Strong hook. I close for offers in your space. Want me to send a Loom breaking down how I'd run your discovery calls?"

THE FOUNDER
EMPATHY

LINKEDIN

#17

"I know founders get pitched by 30 closers a week on LinkedIn. I'm one of them. The difference is I've done the homework on your offer and I have a specific reason I'd be a fit. Want me to send the breakdown?"

THE HONEST
BEGINNER

LINKEDIN

#18

"Cards on the table. I've been closing for 4 months. Booked 80 calls, closed 14. Avg deal £3,200. I'm not the most experienced closer you'll talk to but I'm coachable, I show up, and I have low ego. If you want a hungry junior, here I am."

THE IG STORY
REPLY

INSTAGRAM

#19

"Replying to your story about needing closers. Three months into closing for [related niche]. Happy to take two trial calls this week if you want to see how I run them."

THE IG DM DIRECT
NUMBERS

INSTAGRAM

#20

"11 months closing. £88K in commission earned. 22% avg close rate. Niches: high-ticket coaching and digital products. Open to chat about your offer?"

WHAT TO DO AFTER THE FIRST REPLY

Most closers panic when they get a reply. Don't.

If they say "send me more info": Don't send a wall of text. Send a 2 min Loom. Loom open rates from LinkedIn DMs are 60%+. Text open rates are 25%.

If they say "we're not hiring right now": "Cool. Mind if I follow up in 30 days? Best closers are always the ones who circle back."

If they say "send your CV": Send a one-pager built like a closer reel. Three sections: niches you've closed, total revenue closed, your close rate. Two paragraphs max. Not a corporate CV.

If they say "what's your fee?": "Industry standard commission only. 10 to 20% depending on AOV. No retainer unless you want one."

If they say "let's chat": Send your calendar link. Don't reply with another DM. Send the link.



THE 14-DAY OUTREACH PLAN

If you're sitting on this PDF without an action plan, here's the plan.

Days 1-2: Build a list of 50 targets in 1 to 2 niches you'd be excited to close for. Use LinkedIn Sales Navigator (free trial works) or just regular LinkedIn search. Pull founders, sales leaders, and hiring managers at offers between £3K and £15K. Capture their name, role, company, and one specific detail (recent post, hiring announcement, podcast appearance, anything).

Days 3-12 (10 days): Send 5 personalised connection requests per day on LinkedIn. Use the 200-character note. When they accept, send the full DM from this swipe file. If they don't accept within 5 days, withdraw and InMail. Sprinkle in 1-2 Instagram DMs per day for founders with strong personal brands. Total: 60-70 touches.

Days 13-14: Follow up on every DM that didn't reply. Different angle, second touch. Most replies come on the follow-up.

Expected outcome (based on real Cowboy Closers data):

- 50 LinkedIn connection requests sent
- 20-30 accepted (40-60% on personalised notes)
- 6-12 replies to the follow-up DM
- 2-5 calls booked
- 1-2 trial closer opportunities
- 1 paid placement

That's the floor. Closers who actually follow this convert higher.

If you want the list of 50 founders handed to you, or you want me to review your first 10 DMs before you send them, the next step is connorwestern.com/apply.

Connor



WHERE TO FROM HERE

Send *ten a day*.

You're sitting on twenty real DMs that real closers used to land real roles. The plan is simple. Sales Navigator, connection request, personalised note, then the DM. The reps are the only hard part.

PATH 01 **Days 1-2**

Build a list of 50 targets on LinkedIn (founders, sales leaders, hiring managers) in 1-2 niches you'd be excited to close for. Capture one specific detail on each.

PATH 02 **Days 3-12**

Send 5 personalised connection requests per day. When accepted, send the DM. Withdraw and InMail after 5 days. Sprinkle in 1-2 Instagram DMs daily. Realistic floor: 6-12 replies, 2-5 calls, 1 paid placement.

PATH 03 **Want feedback?**

Inside the Cowboy Closers community we'll review your outreach and roleplay your replies with you weekly.

apply.cowboyclosers.com

Connor